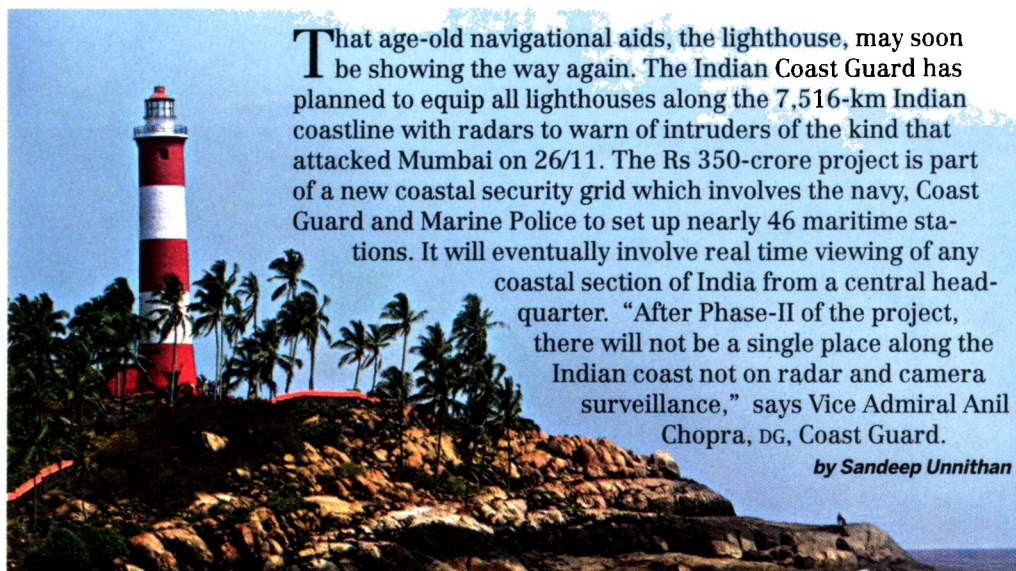


DELHI | Let There be Light



That age-old navigational aids, the lighthouse, may soon be showing the way again. The Indian Coast Guard has planned to equip all lighthouses along the 7,516-km Indian coastline with radars to warn of intruders of the kind that attacked Mumbai on 26/11. The Rs 350-crore project is part of a new coastal security grid which involves the navy, Coast Guard and Marine Police to set up nearly 46 maritime stations. It will eventually involve real time viewing of any coastal section of India from a central head-quarter. "After Phase-II of the project, there will not be a single place along the Indian coast not on radar and camera surveillance," says Vice Admiral Anil Chopra, DG, Coast Guard.

by Sandeep Unnithan

PUNJAB | It's Official

"Punjabi bolo, Punjabi likho, Punjabi padho (speak, write and read Punjabi)" is what the state Government expects its officials to do. Recently, the officers of All-India services received a notification from the Department of Personnel asking them to prove that they have passed the Punjabi test. Officials are now busy ensuring that files headed for all ministers are in Punjabi. Language, they say, is a part of identity. But the Government has taken it a bit too far as other official work is still done in English. by Arvind Chhabra

MORE THAN FIVE HUNDRED FARMERS WILL NOW GET MODERN INFORMATION ON CLIMATE CHANGE.

MUMBAI | Weathering Change

After inadequate rains and reduced harvest last year, the Central Government wants to do all it can to prevent further damage. The All India Coordinated Research Project on Agro-meteorology (AICRPAM), an institute funded by the Centre, will prepare farmers in its four centres in Maharashtra—Akola, Parbhani, Dapoli and Solapur—to prepare farmers to deal with climate change. The Hyderabad-based AICRPAM will educate more than 500 farmers in the state and places across India about weather parameters such as rainfall, temperature, speed of wind, apart from water management and pesticide application.

by Mitali Patel

MISMANAGEMENT HAS MADE THE KOLKATA BOOK FAIR AN EMBARRASSMENT.

KOLKATA | Messy Business

Second only to the Durga Puja in terms of the city's festivities, this year's Kolkata Book Fair has several glitches. First, in a re-run of the Eden Gardens floodlight fiasco, the event's main transformer packed up, plunging the entire fair ground into darkness. State Commerce and Industry Minister Nirupam Sen has ordered an inquiry into the power lapse but other than mere words, the Government allows the fair to keep hurtling towards nothingness. Garbage and stench are its new add-ons this season. The Booksellers and Publishers Guild have a map which contains more errors than facts. The carnival's fall has taken place so rapidly over its last few years. Its most telling reflection: even after being reduced to ashes in 1997, the fair still doesn't have basic firefighting equipment. by Abhijit Dasgupta



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BOOKLOVERS AT THE KOLKATA BOOK FAIR